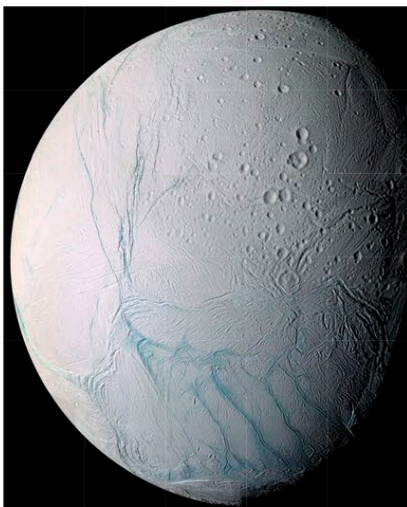
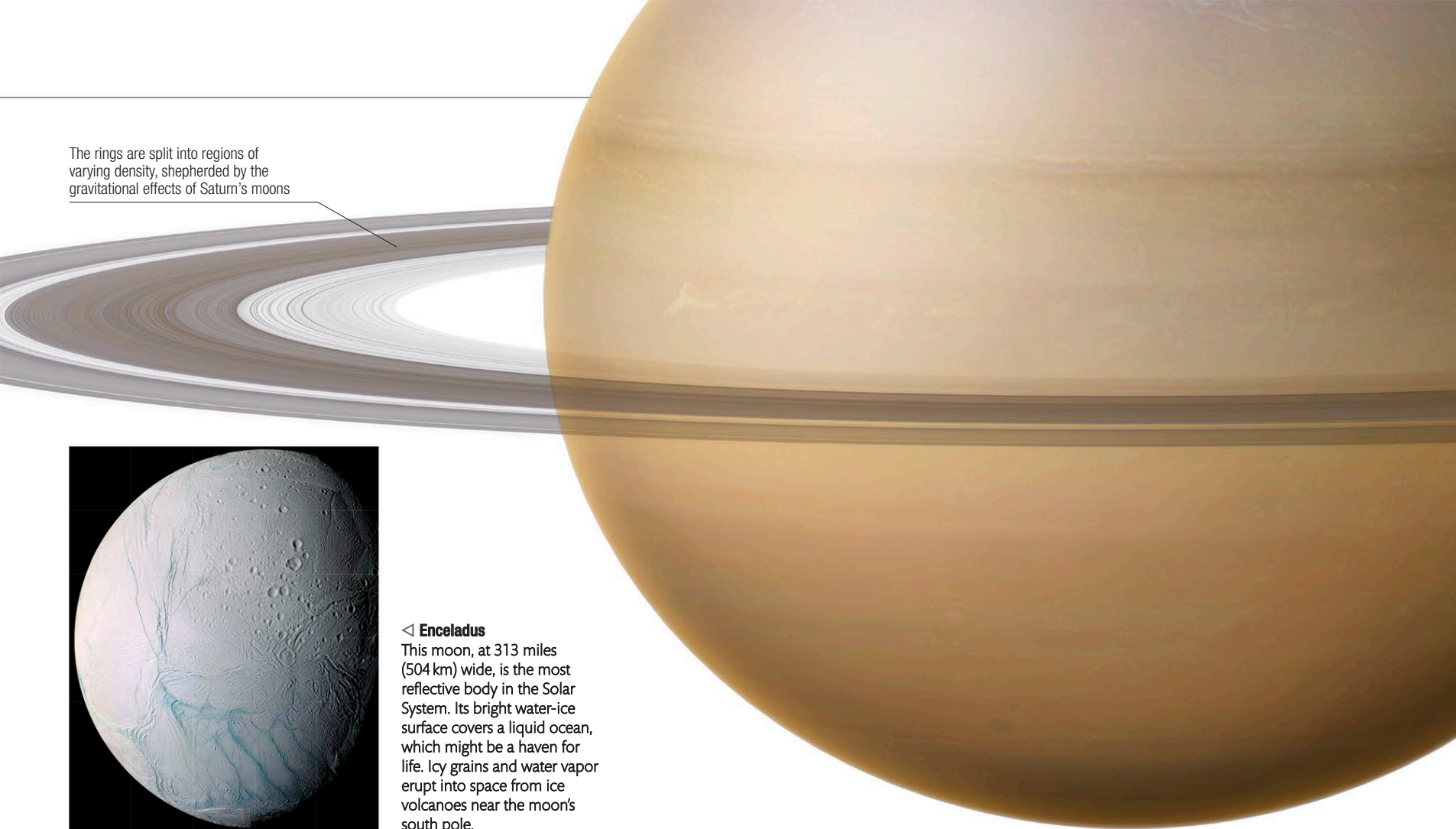


The rings are split into regions of varying density, shepherded by the gravitational effects of Saturn's moons

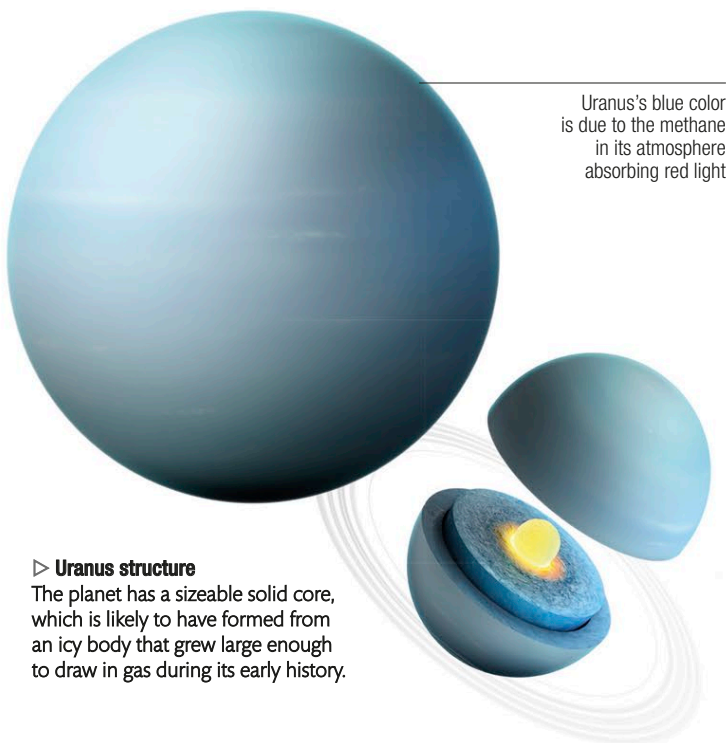


◁ Enceladus

This moon, at 313 miles (504 km) wide, is the most reflective body in the Solar System. Its bright water-ice surface covers a liquid ocean, which might be a haven for life. Icy grains and water vapor erupt into space from ice volcanoes near the moon's south pole.

Uranus

The first planet to be discovered through the use of a telescope, Uranus is a bizarre world. Measuring at 31,763 miles (51,118 km) wide, it spins on its side, resulting in extreme seasons. The atmosphere is very bland around midwinter, but bursts into activity when the Sun heats the equator. The planet's thin rings were first discovered in 1977, when they briefly blocked the light from a distant star.



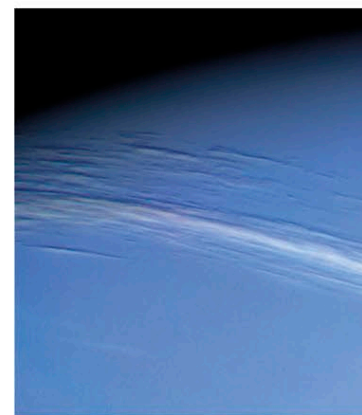
Uranus's blue color is due to the methane in its atmosphere absorbing red light

▷ Uranus structure

The planet has a sizeable solid core, which is likely to have formed from an icy body that grew large enough to draw in gas during its early history.

Neptune

This planet's presence and rough location were predicted due to its effect on other planets. Neptune is 30,500 miles (49,775 km) wide and has a much more active atmosphere than Uranus, possessing huge storms. It has a large moon, Triton, whose backward orbit indicates that it was captured by Neptune in the distant past. Neptune's rings are uneven, consisting of concentrated arcs of material trapped inside tenuous rings.



△ Neptune's clouds

In 1982, after journeying to the far edges of the Solar System, Voyager 2 found a scene reminiscent of Earth. However, these white clouds in Neptune's atmosphere are thought to be frozen methane.



As for all the giant planets, Neptune's atmosphere is primarily hydrogen and helium. Like Uranus, it also contains methane

Neptune's weather activity and fast winds indicate that there's a source of heat in the planet's interior